Haidi Martinidou

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Neuroscience graduate (BSc Glasgow, MSc King's College London) working toward a PhD in computational neuroscience. Combines quantitative training on large clinical and population datasets with hands-on patient-facing research experience.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research centres on the mechanisms underlying maladaptive decision-making and mood dysregulation, particularly reward processing, prediction-error signalling, and reinforcement learning across healthy and clinical populations. This thread connects my past work on fairness-based decision-making and diet-related depression risk. I am also interested in subtler, non-clinical disruptions to self-regulation, including procrastination, optimism, and hormonal influences on cognition. I approach these mechanistic questions as a route toward identifying targets for intervention.

EDUCATION

MSc Psychology and Neuroscience of Mental Health (Merit) 2021 – 2023
King's College London, UK

BSc (Hons) Neuroscience (2:1) 2018 – 2021
University of Glasgow, UK

Advanced entry; Class Representative, 2020–2021.

EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, Anatomy Facility Aug 2026
University of Glasgow

- Week-long research internship under honorary affiliate status, hosted by Dr Ourania Varsou (Senior Lecturer in Anatomy).
- Co-writing a manuscript on generative AI in education; collaboration continues remotely.
- AAUP exchange-programme study (academic exchange in medical education for participants from conflict-affected areas): questionnaire data entry and cleaning, and initial codebook and composite-score design for the analysis.
- Shadowed imaging-phantom development and observed MRI scanning at the university's Imaging Centre.

Independent Research Project — EEG Analysis (OpenMIIR) 2026 (ongoing)

- Self-directed, four-stage EEG pipeline on the OpenMIIR music-imagery dataset: preprocessing, stimulus predictor modelling, TRF encoding, and a generative predictive-coding simulation.
- Using IDyOM to derive per-note surprise and entropy values as predictors of the EEG response to heard and imagined melodies; preprocessing and acoustic predictor stages complete, symbolic (IDyOM) modelling stage in progress.
- Reproducible, version-controlled codebase, built and maintained independently alongside formal coursework.

Fieldwork Specialist 2024 – Mar 2026
IQVIA, Athens

- Coordinated end-to-end patient recruitment for non-interventional clinical research across roughly 20 therapeutic areas, from common chronic conditions to rare diseases, managing initial contact, screening, consent, documentation, diagnosis verification, and scheduling.
- Worked directly with sensitive health data and real-world clinical populations, gaining a practical understanding of the operational demands of recruiting and retaining participants for human-subjects research at scale.
- Liaised with project managers and patient organisations; recognised internally as "Excel and AI Champion" for process improvements that strengthened operational continuity.

Master's Dissertation — Reward, Risk, and Fairness Processing 2022 – 2023
King's College London

"The Connection Between Processing Fairness and Reward-Risk Prediction in the Human Brain"

- Narrative synthesis screening over 350 papers and synthesising 10 in depth, across fMRI, EEG, PET, TMS, and tDCS.

- Concluded that reinforcement-learning prediction-error mechanisms underpin social decision-making, linking reward computation to processes usually studied separately in the fairness literature.
- Supervisor: Dr Gisele Dias.

Undergraduate Dissertation — Diet and Depression Risk 2020 – 2021
University of Glasgow

"The Association Between Mediterranean Diet and Depression Risk"

- Analysed UK Biobank data (N = 502,506) using binary logistic regression in R.
- Engineered a novel dietary-adherence variable in the absence of a ready-made measure, and controlled for multiple confounders; found a modest protective association (OR ≈ 0.91).
- Supervisor: Dr Donald Lyall.

SKILLS

Programming & analysis: R (statistical modelling, regression); Python (MNE-based EEG preprocessing, ICA, epoching; applied in the OpenMIIR/IDyOM pipeline and the Stanford Statistical Learning course); running IDyOM (Common Lisp).

Research methods: Neuroimaging literature synthesis (fMRI, EEG, PET, TMS, tDCS); large-scale dataset management (UK Biobank); EEG signal processing basics (OpenMIIR/IDyOM).

Other: Human-subjects recruitment and data handling; questionnaire data cleaning and codebook design; process documentation and handover; independent web development (see Independent Projects).

Languages: Greek (native); English (fluent); French (basic, learning).

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

- ForFun (2026) — Application tracker for programmes, jobs, and grants (Next.js, Supabase), with an AI-powered Discover tool that searches the web for opportunities.
- VibeDeck (2026) — Spotify playlist and DJ-style web app, built end-to-end and deployed to Cloudflare Workers.
- haidiartin (2026) — Hand-built portfolio site for film photography, painting, and watercolour.

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

- Why GenAI Models Make Things Up — GenAI Unpacked video series (guest author)
- Do, re, mi, we got emotional: what Coldplay did in Athens — Parallaxi Magazine, June 2024
- The human brain and Silicon Valley — Parallaxi Magazine, March 2024
- Essays on neuroscience and everyday behaviour (procrastination, mood, perception, wearables) — Personal website and LinkedIn, 2025 – 2026

CONFERENCES

- NeuroMonster Conference — Rome, June 2026
- Greeks in AI 2026 Symposium — Athens, 15–17 July 2026
  - Opening talk, "Foundational research in the time of AI" — Dr Christos Papadimitriou
  - NeuroAI panel — Constantine Dovrolis, Leontios J. Hadjileontiadis, Maria Papadopouli, Alexandros Potamianos, Stelios Smirnakis, Nektarios Tavernarakis

REFERENCES

- **Dr Ourania Varsou** — University of Glasgow. Research collaborator, GenAI in anatomy education project. Email on request.
- **Dr Donald Lyall** — University of Glasgow. BSc dissertation supervisor. Email on request.